

Assignment 3 -17/SP ELC-721-17SPI
by [Judith Orloff](#) - Wednesday, February 15, 2017, 1:23 PM

ForLee Mahon - Assignment 3, Judith Orloff

Dissolving Adverse Childhood Conditioning through a Mindfulness curriculum for parents and children from Preschool through High School

The problem I am addressing is the inordinate use of drugs, violence, and lack of clarity in young people and the detachments they feel from adults, parents, teachers, etc. The neighborhood is no longer safe. The community is unresponsive to their needs. People of color and women are objectified more as their consciousness grows and these groups become less internally subjugated and more aware of their options. There are no universal tools that can mitigate this violence of mind, heart, body and spirit. There is a proliferation of different therapeutic tools, classes, evidence based models, etc. that support individuals and families. I would like my research and curriculum to be part of that great body of work. I haven't decided what age group to focus on now.

For the past 45 years, I have been exploring methodologies to dissolve negative childhood conditioning. Childhood messages stay subliminally, unknowingly creating deeply reactive responses to situations that may unconsciously be reminiscent to the person or group of what their childhood conditions were. Their survival strategies learned as children take center stage for the moment. The either/or way of thinking takes over and they go into a "trance state" as Four Arrows discusses, and cannot see what is occurring at that moment. Working individually or with a group of people, both children and adults, I have could teach a process of self-awareness that allows them to have new choices rather than succumb to a survival based either/or way of viewing the world.

I wish to create a mindfulness/ self-awareness curriculum for parents and children beginning in pre-school and continuing through high school. For my Theories of Change class with Nicola this semester, I will be exploring Theories of Change with Montessori early childhood education

As a young parent, I didn't understand or even consider how my behavior would affect my children as they developed. *The secret life of the unborn child*, by Thomas Verny, M.D, and John Kelly, 1982, posit the fetus becomes aware and conscious between three to six months in the womb. There are many discussions in the book and the sources described that elaborate on that perspective.

At this time, I have decided to use Phenomenology as my foremost methodology for my dissertation and am preparing a Prezi for Anna's class.

References;

The Secret Life of the Unborn Child, Thomas Verny, M.D. and Johyn Kelly, 1982

Socioemotional development in the toddler years, edited by Celia A. Brownell, Claire B. Kopp, p.134" contrary to previous belief, conditioning is possible in newborns, Ganchrow & Steiner, 1984.

Birth without Violence, Frederick Leboyer, 1974

James, D. K. (2010), Fetal learning: a critical review. *Inf. Child Develop.*, 19: 45-54.
doi:10.1002/icd.653